

Verdant Peak Technologies - Code of Conduct

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1. Introduction

The Verdant Peak Technologies (VPT) Code of Conduct reflects the ethical standards and values that guide how we do business. It applies to every employee, officer, director, and contractor engaged by VPT, regardless of location or role. Every employee is required to certify their understanding of and commitment to this Code annually, and managers are expected to model these standards visibly in their day-to-day leadership. Violations of this Code may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, and in serious cases, referral to law enforcement.

2. Our Core Values

VPT's culture is built on four core values: **Integrity** — we do the right thing even when no one is watching; **Ownership** — we take responsibility for outcomes, not just tasks; **Respect** — we treat every person with dignity regardless of role or background; and **Curiosity** — we seek to learn, question assumptions, and improve continuously. These values inform every policy and decision described in this Code.

3. Fair Treatment and Non-Discrimination

VPT is an equal opportunity employer and prohibits discrimination or harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, marital status, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law, across all employment decisions including hiring, promotion, compensation, and termination. Harassment — including unwelcome comments, jokes, physical conduct, or the display of offensive material — is strictly prohibited, whether it occurs in the office, remotely, at Company events, or on Company communication platforms.

4. Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests could conflict, or appear to conflict, with the interests of VPT. This includes financial interests in competitors, suppliers, or customers; hiring or supervising a relative or close personal relationship without disclosure; and accepting outside employment that interferes with job duties or involves a competitor. Any actual or potential conflict of interest must be disclosed to the employee's manager and the Ethics

& Compliance team via the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form, ideally before the situation arises, and in all cases within 10 working days of becoming aware of it.

5. Gifts, Entertainment, and Anti-Bribery

Employees may not offer, give, solicit, or accept bribes, kickbacks, or improper payments of any kind, to or from any party, in order to obtain or retain business or any improper advantage. Modest business gifts and entertainment (meals, small promotional items) are permitted up to a value of \$75 per person per year from or to any single external party, and must be logged in the Gifts & Entertainment Register maintained by the Ethics & Compliance team if valued over \$25. Gifts to or from government officials are subject to stricter limits and always require pre-approval from Legal, given heightened anti-corruption regulatory scrutiny (e.g., FCPA, UK Bribery Act).

6. Protection of Company Assets and Confidential Information

Employees are entrusted with Company assets — including equipment, funds, intellectual property, and confidential information — and must use them responsibly and only for legitimate business purposes, consistent with the IT Policies. Confidential information (trade secrets, unreleased product plans, customer data, financial results before public disclosure) must not be shared outside VPT, including with family members or former colleagues, both during employment and after departure. Employees who develop inventions, code, or other intellectual property within the scope of their employment assign ownership of that IP to VPT, as detailed in their employment agreement.

7. Insider Trading

Employees who become aware of material non-public information about VPT (such as unannounced financial results, mergers, or major product launches) or about a business partner through their work are prohibited from trading in the relevant company's securities, or "tipping" others to trade, until the information has been made public. Employees at L7 and above and those in Finance, Legal, and Executive roles are subject to additional trading windows and pre-clearance requirements managed by the Legal team.

8. Fair Competition and Antitrust

VPT competes vigorously but fairly. Employees must not engage in discussions with competitors regarding pricing, market allocation, or bid rigging, and must not acquire competitive intelligence through improper means such as misrepresentation, theft, or hacking. Any contact from a competitor that touches on pricing or market strategy, even informally at a conference, must be reported to Legal immediately.

9. Accurate Records and Financial Integrity

All employees must ensure that business records — including expense reports, timesheets, sales figures, and financial statements — are accurate, complete, and created in a timely manner. Deliberately falsifying any Company record is a serious violation of this Code and applicable law, regardless of the amount involved or the employee's intent to "fix it later."

10. Speaking Up and Non-Retaliation

Employees who suspect a violation of this Code, the law, or Company policy are expected to speak up. Reports can be made to a manager, HR Business Partner, the Ethics & Compliance team, or the independent, confidential Ethics Hotline (available 24/7 by phone and web, with anonymous reporting options where permitted by local law). VPT strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith or participates in an investigation, even if the concern is ultimately not substantiated. Retaliation itself is treated as a serious Code violation.

11. Use of Social Media and Public Representation

Employees are free to participate in social media in their personal capacity but must not present personal opinions as official VPT positions, and must not disclose Confidential or Restricted information. Employees who identify as VPT employees on public platforms should exercise good judgment and professionalism consistent with this Code. Only designated Corporate Communications and authorized spokespeople may speak to media, financial analysts, or the public on VPT's behalf.

12. Environmental and Social Responsibility

VPT is committed to conducting business in an environmentally responsible manner and expects the same commitment from its suppliers, as outlined in the Supplier Code of Conduct. Employees involved in procurement decisions should give appropriate weight to sustainability and ethical labor practices when evaluating vendors, in line with VPT's published Sustainability Commitments.

13. Compliance and Certification

All employees must complete Code of Conduct training within 30 days of joining and annually thereafter, and formally certify their compliance through the HR portal. Managers are additionally required to complete a supplemental "Leading with Integrity" module covering their specific responsibilities in identifying and escalating potential Code violations within their teams. This Code is reviewed annually by the Ethics & Compliance team and the Board Audit Committee, and material updates are communicated to all employees.